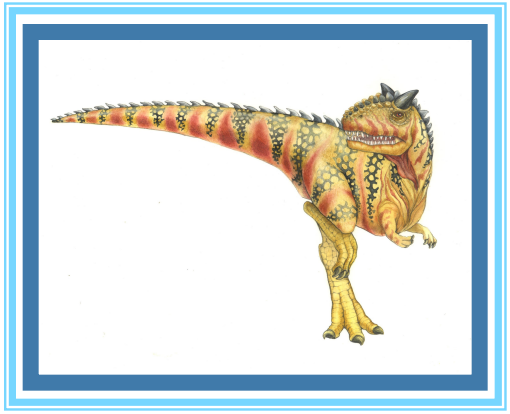
Chapter 1: Introduction



Silberschatz, Galvin and Gagne ©2013



What is an Operating System?

- A program that acts as an intermediary between a user of a computer and the computer hardware
- Operating system goals:
  - Execute user programs and make solving user problems easier
  - Make the computer system convenient to use
  - Use the computer hardware in an efficient manner





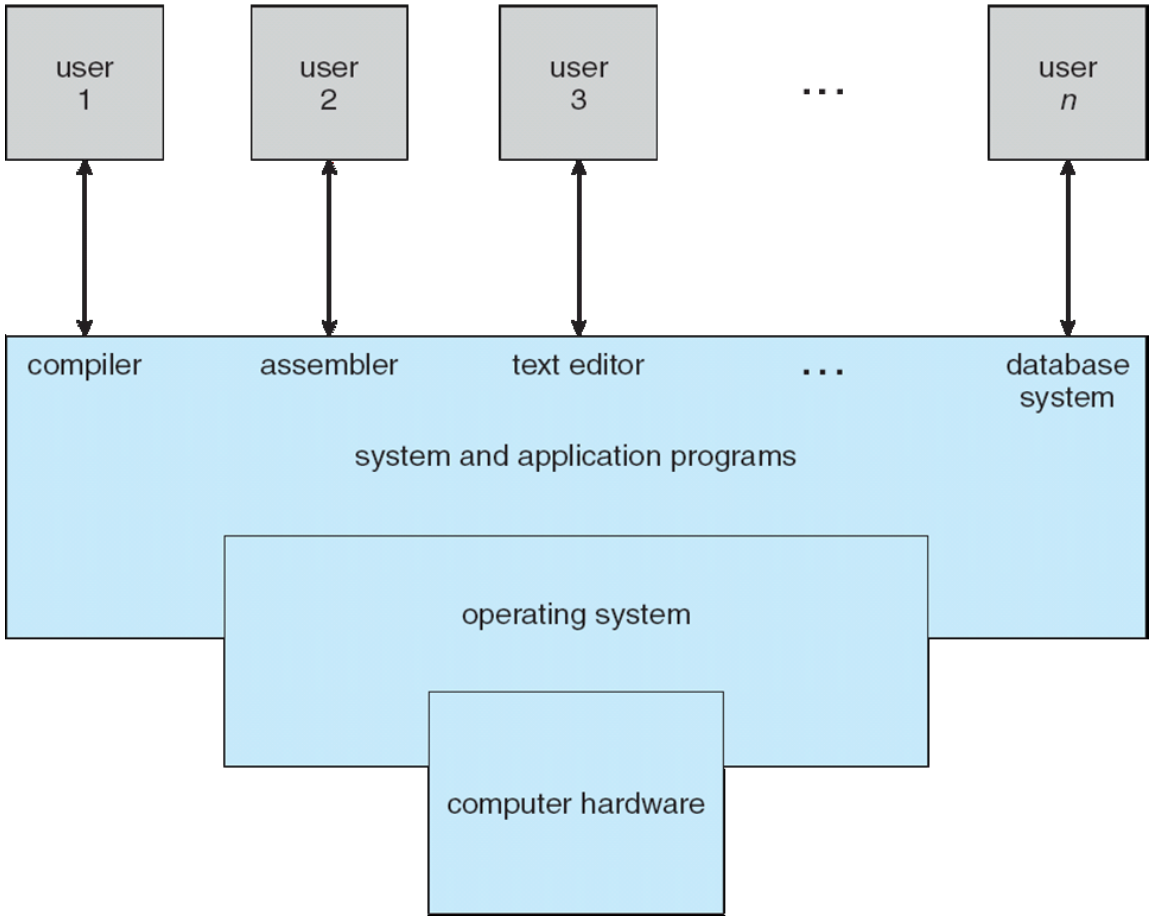
Computer System Structure

- Computer system can be divided into four components:
  - Hardware – provides basic computing resources
    - CPU, memory, I/O devices
  - Operating system
    - Controls and coordinates use of hardware among various applications and users
  - Application programs – define the ways in which the system resources are used to solve the computing problems of the users
    - Word processors, compilers, web browsers, database systems, video games
  - Users
    - People, machines, other computers





Four Components of a Computer System







What Operating Systems Do

- Depends on the point of view
- Users want convenience, **ease of use**
  - Don't care about **resource utilization**
- But shared computer such as **mainframe** or **minicomputer** must keep all users happy
- Users of dedicate systems such as **workstations** have dedicated resources but frequently use shared resources from **servers**
- Handheld computers are resource poor, optimized for usability and battery life
- Some computers have little or no user interface, such as embedded computers in devices and automobiles





Operating System Definition

- OS is a **resource allocator**
  - Manages all resources
  - Decides between conflicting requests for efficient and fair resource use
- OS is a **control program**
  - Controls execution of programs to prevent errors and improper use of the computer





Operating System Definition (Cont.)

- No universally accepted definition
- "Everything a vendor ships when you order an operating system" is good approximation
  - But varies wildly
- "The one program running at all times on the computer" is the **kernel**. Everything else is either a system program (ships with the operating system) or an application program.





Computer Startup

- **bootstrap program** is loaded at power-up or reboot
  - Typically stored in ROM or EPROM, generally known as **firmware**
  - Initializes all aspects of system
  - Loads operating system kernel and starts execution





Computer-System Operation

- I/O devices and the CPU can execute concurrently
- Each device controller is in charge of a particular device type
- Each device controller has a local buffer
- CPU moves data from/to main memory to/from local buffers
- I/O is from the device to local buffer of controller
- Device controller informs CPU that it has finished its operation by causing an interrupt





Common Functions of Interrupts

- Interrupt transfers control to the interrupt service routine generally, through the **interrupt vector**, which contains the addresses of all the service routines
- Interrupt architecture must save the address of the interrupted instruction
- A **trap** or **exception** is a software-generated interrupt caused either by an error or a user request
- An operating system is **interrupt driven**





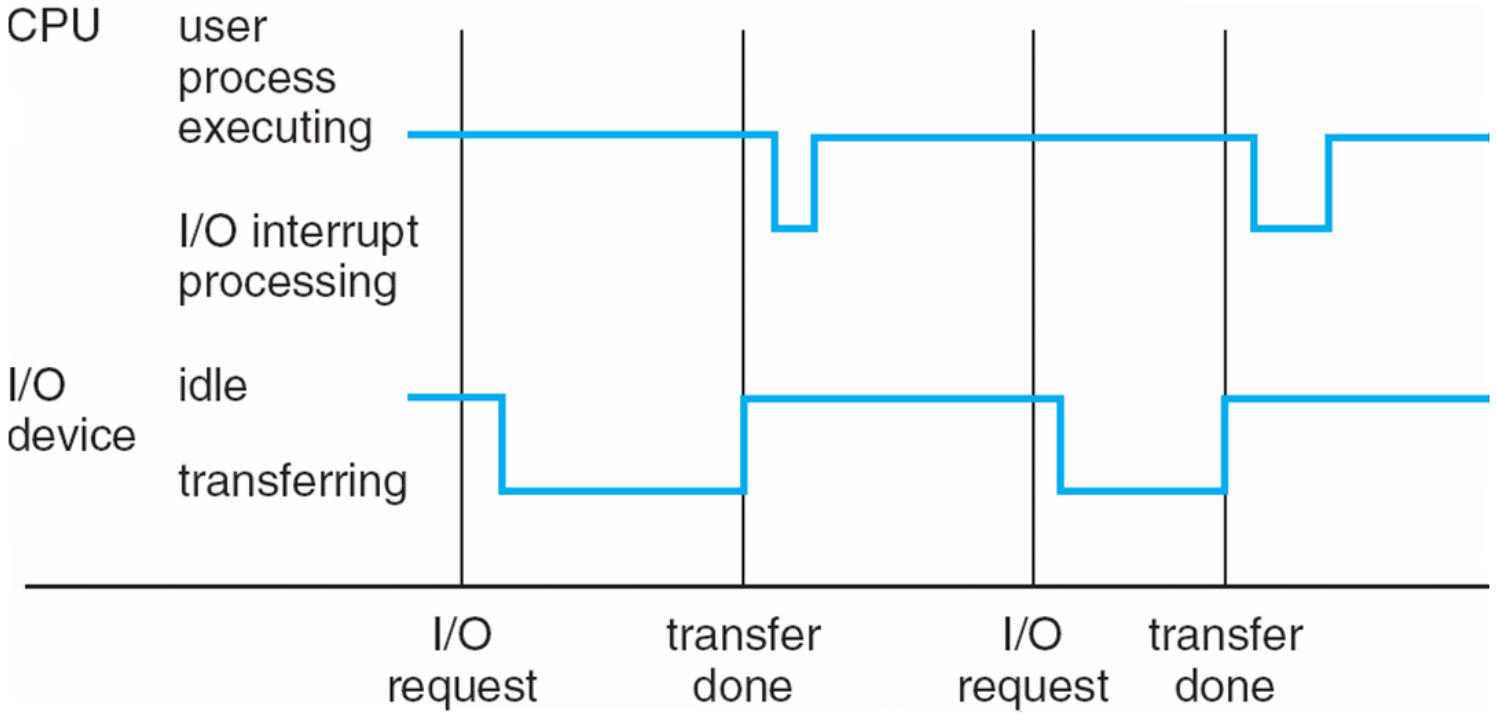
Interrupt Handling

- The operating system preserves the state of the CPU by storing registers and the program counter
- Determines which type of interrupt has occurred:
  - **polling**
  - **vectored** interrupt system
- Separate segments of code determine what action should be taken for each type of interrupt





Interrupt Timeline

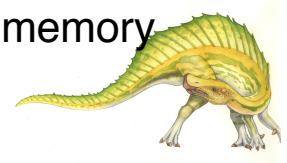






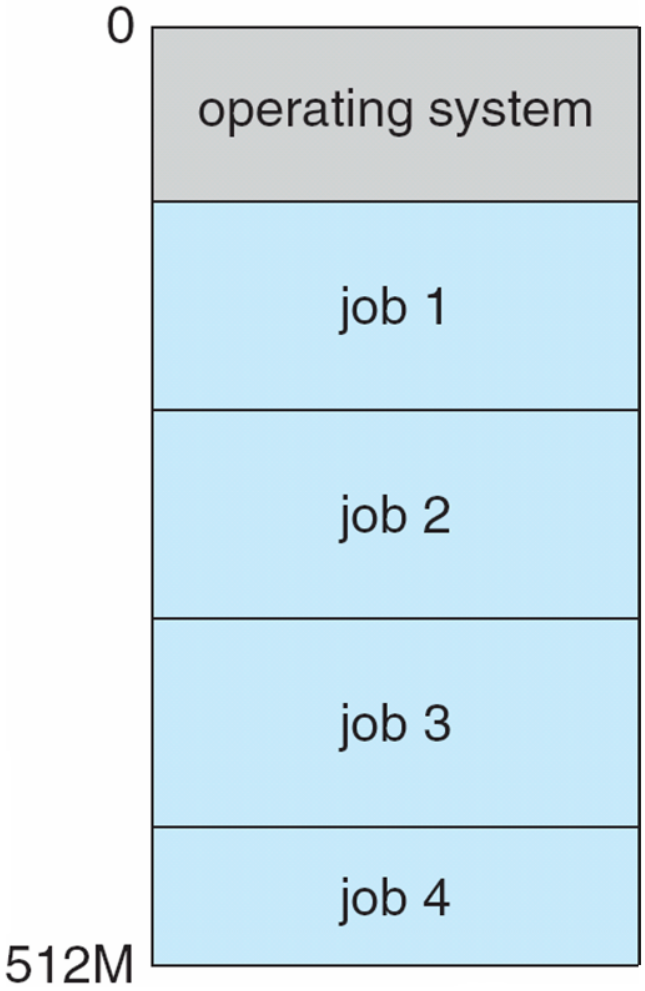
Operating System Structure

- **Multiprogramming** needed for efficiency
  - Single user cannot keep CPU and I/O devices busy at all times
  - Multiprogramming organizes jobs (code and data) so CPU always has one to execute
  - A subset of total jobs in system is kept in memory
  - One job selected and run via **job scheduling**
  - When it has to wait (for I/O for example), OS switches to another job
- **Timesharing** (**multitasking**) is logical extension in which CPU switches jobs so frequently that users can interact with each job while it is running, creating **interactive** computing
  - **Response time** should be < 1 second
  - Each user has at least one program executing in memory ⇨ **process**
  - If several jobs ready to run at the same time ⇨ **CPU scheduling**
  - If processes don't fit in memory, **swapping** moves them in and out to run
  - **Virtual memory** allows execution of processes not completely in memory





Memory Layout for Multiprogrammed System







Operating-System Operations

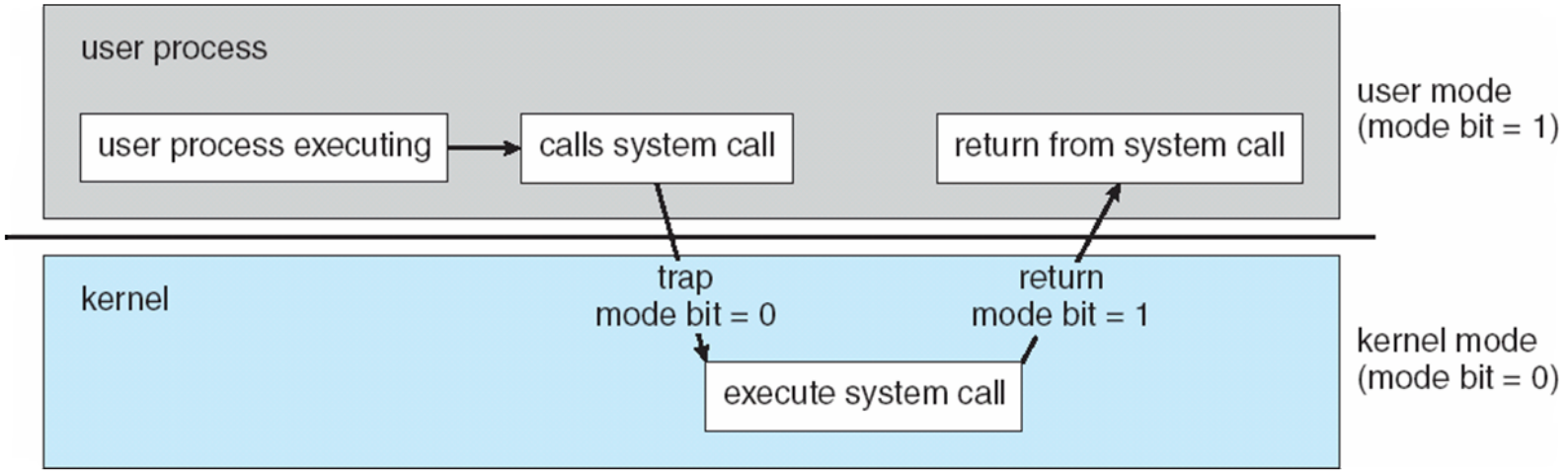
- **Interrupt driven** by hardware
- Software error or request creates **exception** or **trap**
  - Division by zero, request for operating system service
- Other process problems include infinite loop, processes modifying each other or the operating system
- **Dual-mode** operation allows OS to protect itself and other system components
  - **User mode** and **kernel mode**
  - **Mode bit** provided by hardware
    - Provides ability to distinguish when system is running user code or kernel code
    - Some instructions designated as **privileged**, only executable in kernel mode
    - System call changes mode to kernel, return from call resets it to user
- Increasingly CPUs support multi-mode operations
  - i.e. **virtual machine manager** (**VMM**) mode for guest **VMs**





Transition from User to Kernel Mode

- Timer to prevent infinite loop / process hogging resources
  - Set interrupt after specific period
  - Operating system decrements counter
  - When counter zero generate an interrupt
  - Set up before scheduling process to regain control or terminate program that exceeds allotted time







I/O Structure

- After I/O starts, control returns to user program only upon I/O completion
  - Wait instruction idles the CPU until the next interrupt
  - Wait loop (contention for memory access)
  - At most one I/O request is outstanding at a time, no simultaneous I/O processing

- After I/O starts, control returns to user program without waiting for I/O completion
  - **System call** – request to the OS to allow user to wait for I/O completion
  - **Device-status table** contains entry for each I/O device indicating its type, address, and state
  - OS indexes into I/O device table to determine device status and to modify table entry to include interrupt





Direct Memory Access Structure

- Used for high-speed I/O devices able to transmit information at close to memory speeds
- Device controller transfers blocks of data from buffer storage directly to main memory without CPU intervention
- Only one interrupt is generated per block, rather than the one interrupt per byte





Storage Structure

- Main memory – only large storage media that the CPU can access directly
  - **Random access**
  - Typically **volatile**
- Secondary storage – extension of main memory that provides large **nonvolatile** storage capacity
- Magnetic disks – rigid metal or glass platters covered with magnetic recording material
  - Disk surface is logically divided into **tracks**, which are subdivided into **sectors**
  - The **disk controller** determines the logical interaction between the device and the computer
- **Solid-state disks** – faster than magnetic disks, nonvolatile
  - Various technologies
  - Becoming more popular





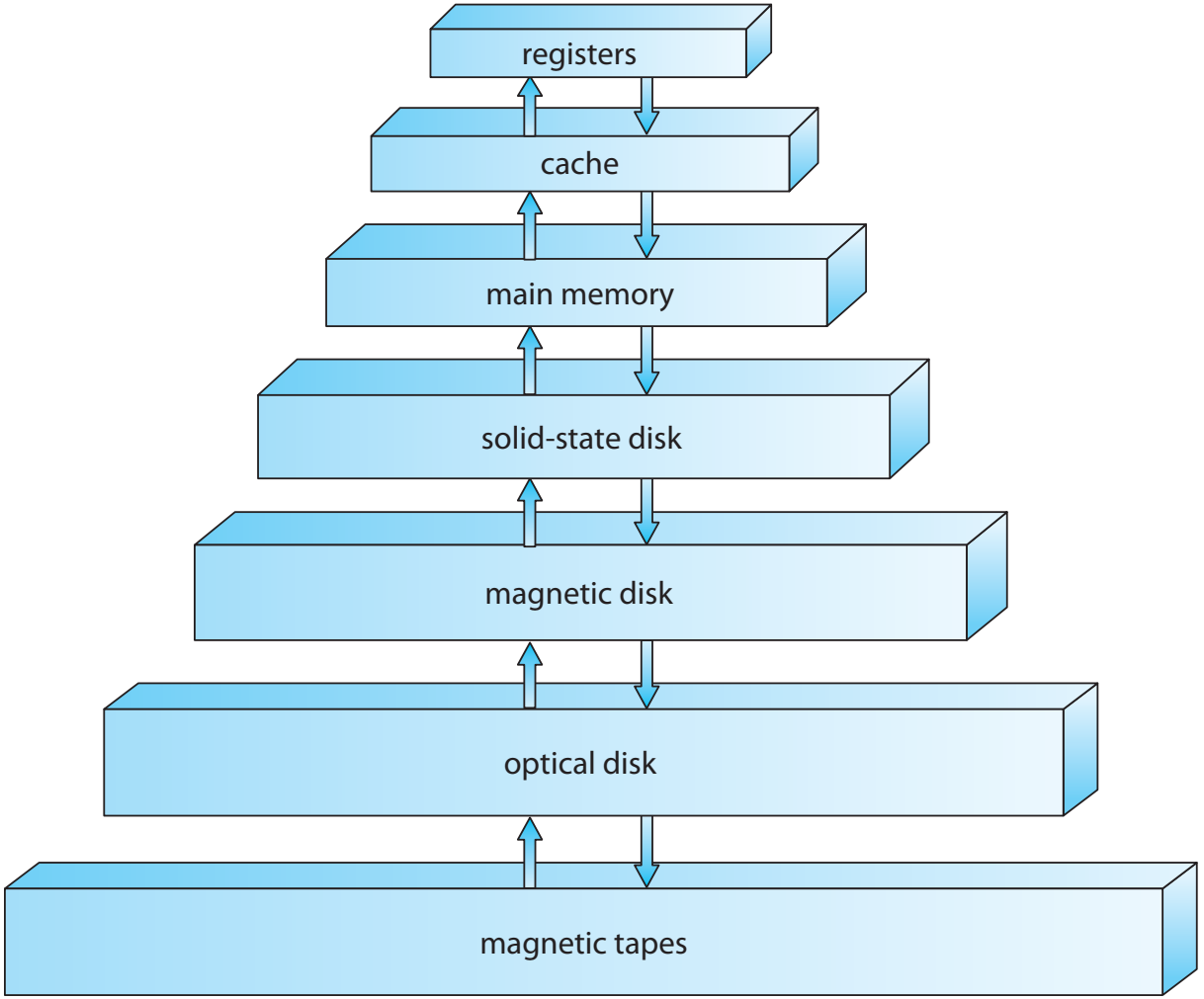
Storage Hierarchy

- Storage systems organized in hierarchy
  - Speed
  - Cost
  - Volatility
- **Caching** – copying information into faster storage system; main memory can be viewed as a cache for secondary storage
- **Device Driver** for each device controller to manage I/O
  - Provides uniform interface between controller and kernel





Storage-Device Hierarchy







Caching

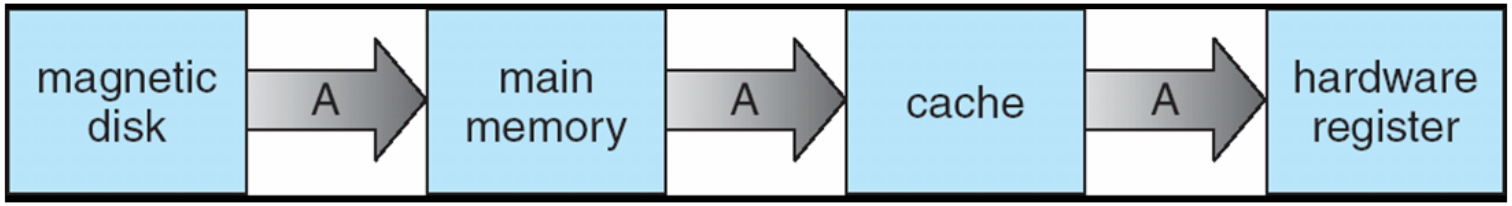
- Important principle, performed at many levels in a computer (in hardware, operating system, software)
- Information in use copied from slower to faster storage temporarily
- Faster storage (cache) checked first to determine if information is there
  - If it is, information used directly from the cache (fast)
  - If not, data copied to cache and used there
- Cache smaller than storage being cached
  - Cache management important design problem
  - Cache size and replacement policy





Migration of Integer A from Disk to Register

- Multitasking environments must be careful to use most recent value, no matter where it is stored in the storage hierarchy



- Multiprocessor environment must provide **cache coherency** in hardware such that all CPUs have the most recent value in their cache





Performance of Various Levels of Storage

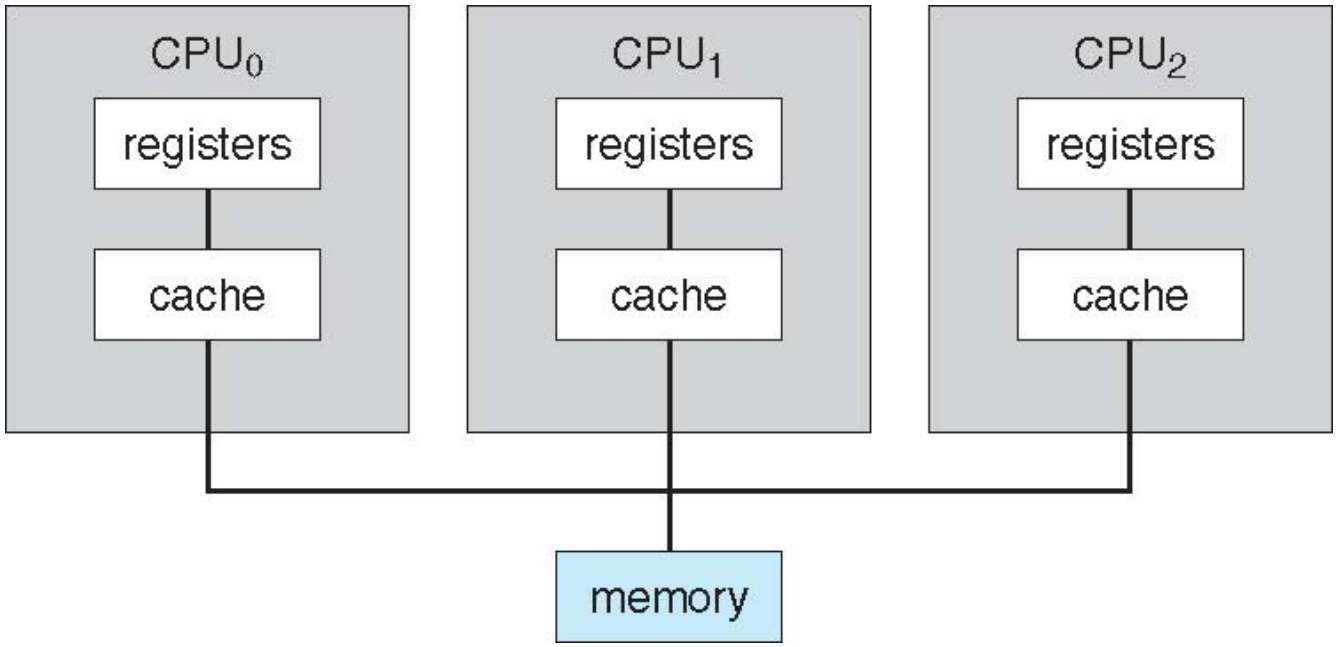
Level	1	2	3	4	5
Name	registers	cache	main memory	solid state disk	magnetic disk
Typical size	< 1 KB	< 16MB	< 64GB	< 1 TB	< 10 TB
Implementation technology	custom memory with multiple ports CMOS	on-chip or off-chip CMOS SRAM	CMOS SRAM	flash memory	magnetic disk
Access time (ns)	0.25 - 0.5	0.5 - 25	80 - 250	25,000 - 50,000	5,000,000
Bandwidth (MB/sec)	20,000 - 100,000	5,000 - 10,000	1,000 - 5,000	500	20 - 150
Managed by	compiler	hardware	operating system	operating system	operating system
Backed by	cache	main memory	disk	disk	disk or tape

- Movement between levels of storage hierarchy can be explicit or implicit





Symmetric Multiprocessing Architecture







Computing Environments - Virtualization

- Allows operating systems to run applications within other OSes
  - Vast and growing industry
- **Emulation** used when source CPU type different from target type (i.e. PowerPC to Intel x86)
  - Generally slowest method
  - When computer language not compiled to native code – **Interpretation**
- **Virtualization** – OS natively compiled for CPU, running **guest** OSes also natively compiled
  - Consider VMware running WinXP guests, each running applications, all on native WinXP **host** OS
  - **VMM** provides virtualization services





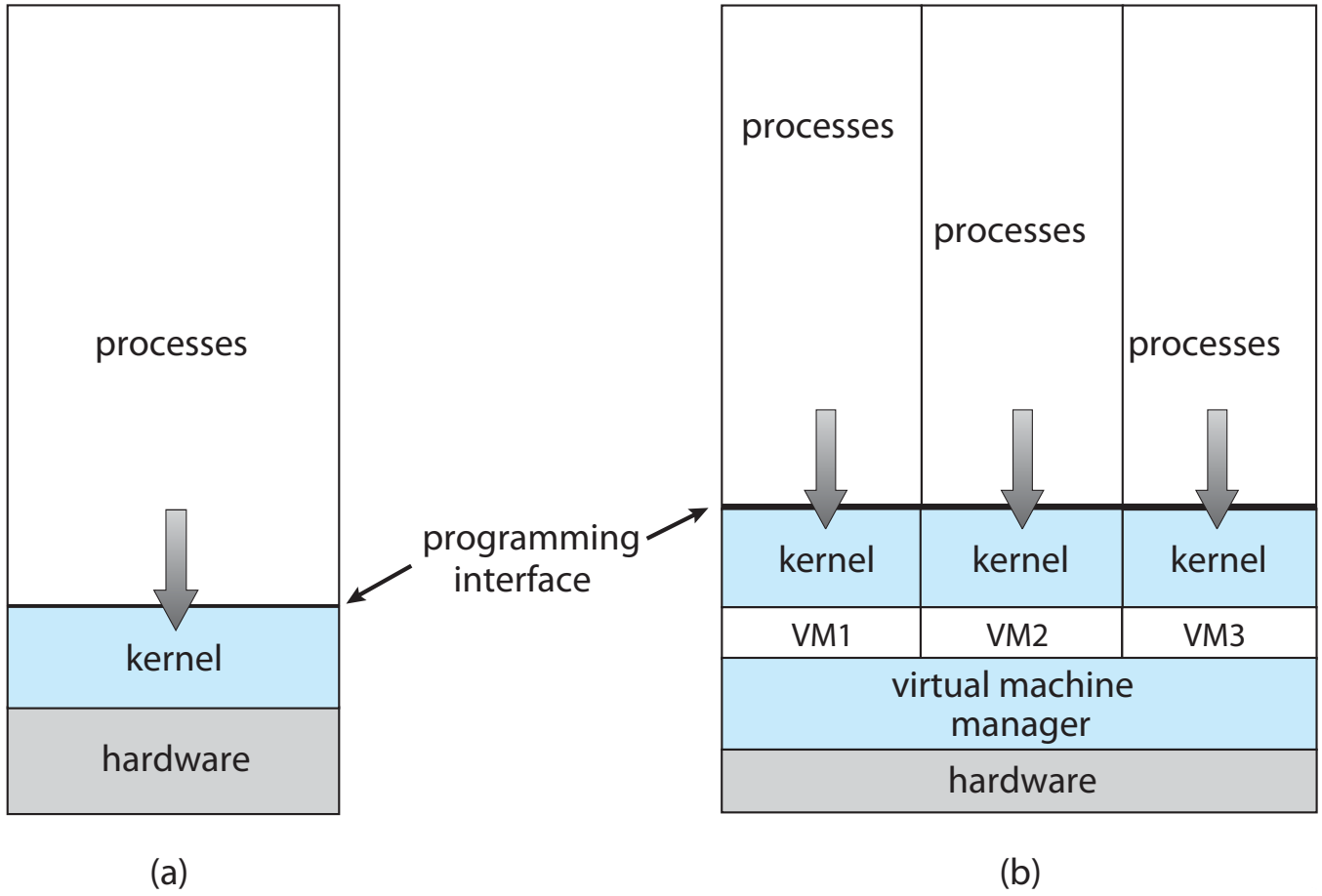
Computing Environments - Virtualization

- Use cases involve laptops and desktops running multiple OSes for exploration or compatibility
  - Apple laptop running Mac OS X host, Windows as a guest
  - Developing apps for multiple OSes without having multiple systems
  - QA testing applications without having multiple systems
  - Executing and managing compute environments within data centers
- VMM can run natively, in which case they are also the host
  - There is no general purpose host then (VMware ESX and Citrix XenServer)





Computing Environments - Virtualization







Computing Environments – Cloud Computing

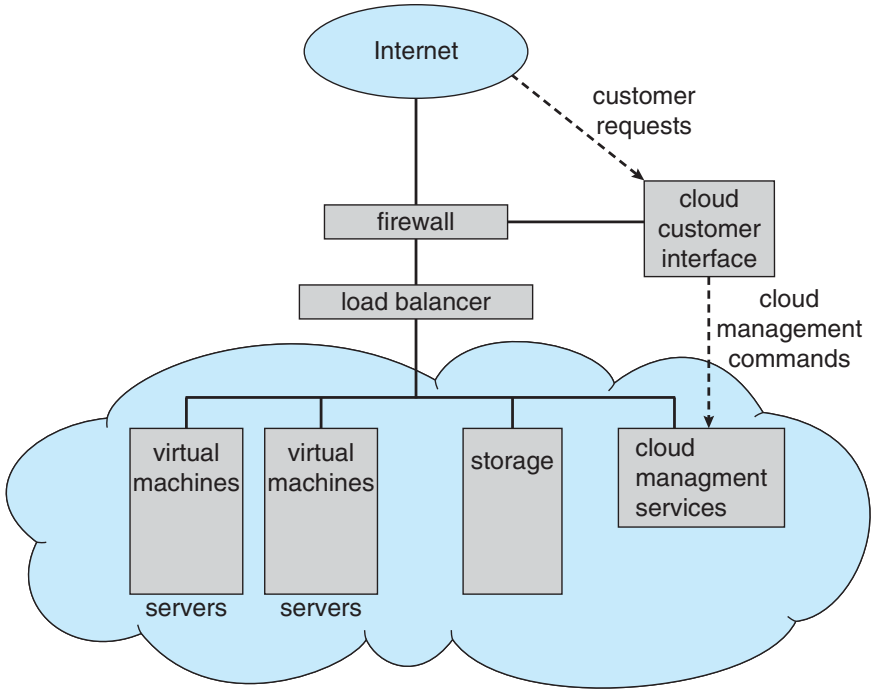
- Delivers computing, storage, even apps as a service across a network
- Logical extension of virtualization as based on virtualization
  - Amazon **EC2** has thousands of servers, millions of VMs, PBs of storage available across the Internet, pay based on usage
- Many types
  - **Public cloud** – available via Internet to anyone willing to pay
  - **Private cloud** – run by a company for the company's own use
  - **Hybrid cloud** – includes both public and private cloud components
  - Software as a Service (**SaaS**) – one or more applications available via the Internet (i.e. word processor)
  - Platform as a Service (**PaaS**) – software stack ready for application use via the Internet (i.e a database server)
  - Infrastructure as a Service (**IaaS**) – servers or storage available over Internet (i.e. storage available for backup use)





Computing Environments – Cloud Computing

- Cloud compute environments composed of traditional OSes, plus VMMs, plus cloud management tools
  - Internet connectivity requires security like firewalls
  - Load balancers spread traffic across multiple applications







Computing Environments – Real-Time Embedded Systems

- Real-time embedded systems most prevalent form of computers
  - Vary considerable, special purpose, limited purpose OS, **real-time OS**
  - Use expanding
- Many other special computing environments as well
  - Some have OSes, some perform tasks without an OS
- Real-time OS has well-defined fixed time constraints
  - Processing ***must*** be done within constraint
  - Correct operation only if constraints met

